DEPARTMENT OF
curriculum
+instruction

Literacy education

Timing

1. Discuss written preliminary exam with your advisor as you near completion of your coursework
2. Typically, you will have 4 to 6 weeks to complete the written exam
3. The committee member reads the exam and informs and your adviser of the outcome within 2-3 weeks
4. We recommend that you begin the process of scheduling your oral exam within two or three weeks of passing written exams

Written Exam

The prelim should demonstrate that you can integrate and synthesize past and current doctoral work in the interest of moving forward to the dissertation

Take home. You will write two papers: one for your advisor and the second for a committee member (decided with advisor; in certain cases, a third paper may be written). You will consult with your advisor and committee member with regard to paper topics and scope.

Each paper is read by the faculty member who is overseeing the paper, who will also communicate the results to you and your adviser. Revisions and second opportunities to write papers must be completed within the next academic term.

Grading may result in a *Pass*, a *Deferred Pass* (with conditions), or a *Fail*. If both papers result in a *Pass*, you will proceed to the oral preliminary examination stage. If either paper results in a *Deferred Pass*, you will be notified of what is required in order to have the conditions removed. If either paper results in a *Fail*, matriculation is suspended and you must request permission to rewrite the paper. If you pass after revisions are made, doctoral status is restored; if you fail after revisions, you will be counseled out of the program.

Oral Exam

Discussion of dissertation depends on the extent that this was treated in written exams.

The oral exam tends to focus on topics and questions raised by written exams, but will also cover general knowledge gained through coursework.